

# C. Luke Watson

Center for Financial Research  
Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation  
Washington, D.C.

Phone: (757) 537 - 0991  
Email: [chwatson@fdic.gov](mailto:chwatson@fdic.gov)  
Research: [clukewatson.github.io](https://github.com/clukewatson)

## Research Interests

Public Economics, Urban Economics, Industrial Organization  
Tax Incidence, Imperfect Information, Bank Branching, Online Bank Competition

## Employment

|                                                                 |                     |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| Senior Financial Economist, Center for Financial Research, FDIC | Aug 2023            |
| Financial Economist, Center for Financial Research, FDIC        | Aug 2021 - Aug 2023 |

## Education

|                                            |             |
|--------------------------------------------|-------------|
| Ph.D. Economics, Michigan State University | 2015 - 2021 |
| M.A. Economics, Old Dominion University    | 2013 - 2015 |
| B.A. Economics, Old Dominion University    | 2009 - 2013 |

## Working Papers

|                                                                        |      |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| “A Test for Pricing Power in Urban Housing Markets” (with O.Ziv)       | 2024 |
| – Revision requested, Review of Economics and Statistics               |      |
| “Is the Rent Too High: Land Ownership and Monopoly Power” (with O.Ziv) | 2021 |

## Works in Progress

“Bank Website Adoption and Implications”  
“CBDC News and Market Sentiment”  
“Estimating Spatial Retail Banking Markets”

## Prior Employment

|                                                                                        |             |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| Instructor : Development Economics (Michigan State University)                         | Fall 2020   |
| Instructor : Principles of Microeconomics (Old Dominion University)                    | Summer 2015 |
| TA : (MSU) Public Revenues, Ec. of Poverty & Income, Int'l Trade (x4), Urban Econ (x3) |             |
| Interm.Micro, Intro.Micro, Intro.Macro                                                 | 2015-2020   |
| TA : (AEASP) Foundations Microeconomics and Mathematics                                | Summer 2017 |
| RA : (MSU) Oren Ziv, Prabhat Barnwal, (ODU) Gary Wagner, Tim Komarek                   | 2013-2020   |
| Barista : Starbucks                                                                    | 2009-2015   |

## Presentations

2024: Lincoln Institute UE & PE Conference. 2023: Mid-Atlantic Trade Workshop, NTA.  
2022: AREUEA / ASSA, AREUEA Nat'l, NTA, UEA (USA). 2021: UEA (Europe).  
2020: Ohio University, MVEA, NTA. 2019: NTA.

## Dissertation Work on EITC

|                                                                                      |      |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| “The General Equilibrium Incidence of the Earned Income Tax Credit”                  | 2021 |
| “Estimating Supply & Demand Elasticities Using a Single Tax Rate with GE Spillovers” | 2021 |
| “The Local Labor Market Effects of State EITC Supplements”                           | 2021 |

## Service

|                                                                          |           |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| FDIC - History of the FDIC presenter                                     | 2024–tbd  |
| FDIC - CFR Seminar Coordinator                                           | 2022-2024 |
| FDIC - Reader for FDIC Consumer Research Symposium                       | 2022-2023 |
| Michigan State University - Applied Economics Student Workshop Organizer | 2017-2020 |
| Michigan State University - Graduate Student Seminar Organizer           | 2018-2020 |
| Michigan State University - Graduate Instruction Committee               | 2017-2018 |
| Old Dominion University - Ad Hoc Committee on Birthday Singing           | 2013-2015 |

## Projects

|                                                                        |      |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| FDIC - Options for Deposit Insurance Reform                            | 2023 |
| FDIC - Literature Review on Digital Currencies and Financial Stability | 2022 |

## Referee

|                                                                                                                                         |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Contemporary Economic Policy, International Tax and Public Finance, Journal of Real Estate Finance and Economics, Public Finance Review |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

## Awards and Grants

|                                                            |           |
|------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Dissertation Completion Fellowship (MSU)                   | 2020      |
| Outstanding Graduate Economics Student Award (ODU)         | 2015      |
| Graduate Student Tuition Fellowship (ODU)                  | 2013-2015 |
| Constant Dominion Business Student Merit Scholarship (ODU) | 2013      |
| Town-N-Gown Scholarship (ODU)                              | 2013      |
| Governor’s Technology Tuition Scholarship (ODU)            | 2009-2013 |
| Time Magazine Person of the Year (shared)                  | 2006      |

## Memberships

|                                                                                |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| American Real Estate and Urban Economics Association, National Tax Association |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

## Skills

Strong: R, Stata, MATLAB, Julia. Passing: Python, Gauss. Weak: ArcGIS, SAS.